

able to occupy a decent market with its Android operating system. This is also contributed to by Amazon, which produces an extremely budget tight alternative—the \$200 Kindle Fire, which commands about 16.8% of the market in terms of sales right now. The most interesting aspect of these statistics is that the combined sale of tablets has risen by up to 155% compared to the same time period in 2010. This definitely shows that the tablets are here to stay.

But now the question is: is the tablet right for you, and if you choose to decide yes, then which tablet is right for you? Considering the options, you



The mighty iPad, along with Samsung Galaxy Tab and the Playbook

might already be interested in an iPad or one of the many cheaper Android tablets. You even have the BlackBerry PlayBook in the mix as well as the Microsoft Windows 8 variety coming in. But let's see what key factors you should be considering before making the decision.

Do you really need a tablet?

Let's look at this question from another angle. To put it simply, tablets might not be able to really fulfil all your digital computing needs. They still cannot act as alternatives or replacements to your full-fledged computers or even your smartphones for that matter. In a way a tablet is a big touch screen media device that brings together your portable media player, and a simple gaming device and has a larger screen. A lot of tablets do have features for mobile services, but they are still neither a good phone nor can be used to make phone calls via a traditional mobile provider. While you can still handle the issue of productivity on an iPad or an Android tablet, which are fairly